



September 14th 2017 Delaware County Redevelopment Commission Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BpJVSP8HNe0
Publication Date	2017-09-19T14:16:55Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Body: Delaware County Redevelopment Commission (*referenced in transcript*)

Document Type: Comprehensive Meeting Analysis & Summary

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

No statutory public hearings or separate committee work sessions were held immediately prior to the regular meeting call to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:11](#). Specific calendar dates discussed for future actions include October 3rd and October 12th.
- **Attendance:** Specific roll-call attendance was not explicitly read into the transcript record. Board members and staff participating or referenced by name include Roger, Brad, Bill Walters, and Todd Murray.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance 00:00:11.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *Not addressed in the provided transcript text.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:00:47 **J. Crew Landscaping Services Headquarters Relocation Project**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad (Business Owner / Representative) and Bill Walters (Business Retention & Expansion).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brad presented a proposal to relocate the J. Crew Landscaping Services corporate headquarters from the northern edge of its service area in Lansing to a 3.5-acre property on South Street in Daleville, Delaware County. The project involves building a 9,000-square-foot facility, bringing approximately 35 jobs to the area. The proposal requests assistance with land acquisition and infrastructure upgrades. Staff noted that surrounding property and business owners are very enthusiastic about the project and anticipated traffic improvements.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this agenda item.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (motion to have Brad move forward with discussion and authorization for work on access points/sidewalks).
- 00:04:21 **Roadway Project Bidding Schedule & Phase 1 Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Roger / Board Engineering Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff provided a scheduling update on the local roadway project. Funds and bonds are secured, and permits could be initiated as early as September 30th, targeting a six-month winter construction window with completion projected around June or July. The board discussed opening bids on Thursday, October 12th at 9:00 AM, preceded by a pre-bid meeting on Tuesday, October 3rd. Staff also proposed splitting Phase 1 into sub-phases (1B1 and 1B2) to allow adequate review time for crosswalk, brick pavers, and irrigation system options.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus reached to set the bid opening for October 12th and pre-bid meeting for October 3rd.
- 00:08:59 **Release of Brownfield Escrow Funds (TFS Bethel Site / Muncie Corporation)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Todd Murray (Muncie Corporation) / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff presented a letter and request from Todd Murray regarding the TFS Bethel site. Brownfield environmental remediation at the site is complete and approved by the Indiana Department of Environmental Management (IDEM). Approximately \$20,000 of state underground storage tank funds were utilized, leaving roughly \$30,000 remaining in escrow at Old National Bank.

Mr. Murray requested the release of these escrow funds. Staff recommended approval, highlighting the project as a major job creation success story.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to release the escrow funds.
 - **00:11:03 Property Acquisition & Environmental Cleanup Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Legal Counsel / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed a final purchase agreement for property acquisition involving environmental cleanup. Under the terms, the buyer acquires the property, agrees to address environmental issues, and the seller agrees to demolish all existing improvements to leave flat grassland prior to closing (targeted for September 26th). Counsel noted provisions requiring the seller to reimburse the Commission if they fail to perform demolition obligations. Discussion ensued regarding environmental liabilities, potential state trust fund cost-sharing (seeking higher than the standard 40% reimbursement), and consulting with an environmental expert for estimated cleanup costs at the next meeting.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to execute and finalize the purchase agreement.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:20:18 Resident Comment (Unnamed / General Public)**
 - **Key Concerns:** Inquired about the geographical and tax jurisdiction (Daleville vs. Chesterfield) of the J. Crew landscaping project and roadway/infrastructure maintenance. Warned the board about the extreme financial risks and liabilities associated with acquiring brownfield sites or old service stations with underground storage tanks based on past county experiences. Advised the Commission to move quickly on acquiring surrounding properties (such as the old bike shop and adjacent properties) before real estate values rise due to the current development.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Upcoming pre-bid meeting scheduled for October 3rd.
 - Bid opening scheduled for October 12th at 9:00 AM.
 - Property closing targeted for September 26th.
 - Environmental consultant scheduled to present estimated cleanup costs and state trust fund cost-recovery options at the next meeting.
- **Adjournment:** *The transcript concludes following public forum discussions without a formally stated timestamped adjournment vote.*

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